

TO-DAY'S TELEGRAMS

REGULAR ASSOCIATED PRESS DISPATCHES TO THE DAILY PRESS.

THE CONVENTION.

Afternoon Session.
SABATINO, Jan. 27.—The Convention assembled at 2 o'clock. President...

The chair ruled in effect that sections which had been stricken out in Committee of the Whole were not before the Convention.

Section 7 was brought at length. It provides that three-fourths of a majority may render a verdict in certain civil cases and misdemeanors.

Herrington offered an amendment to arrange a unanimous verdict except in cases where it is adopted.

Amendment offered in relation to the section in the language of the existing Constitution. Rejected. The section was adopted. Barry gave notice of reconsideration.

Section 8 was not considered. It reads: "Officers hereafter required to be prosecuted by indictment shall be prosecuted by indictment or by information after commitment and examination by a magistrate, as may be prescribed by law, but the grand jury shall have the right to return a bill of indictment in any county. The substitute, in the language of the standing committee's section, was rejected. The section was adopted 19 yeas, 20 nays.

Section 9, relating to the liberty of speech, was not considered. It reads: "The press shall be free, and also to publish any news in any county. The substitute, in the language of the standing committee's section, was rejected. The section was adopted 19 yeas, 20 nays.

Section 10, relating to the liberty of speech, was not considered. It reads: "The press shall be free, and also to publish any news in any county. The substitute, in the language of the standing committee's section, was rejected. The section was adopted 19 yeas, 20 nays.

Section 11, relating to the liberty of speech, was not considered. It reads: "The press shall be free, and also to publish any news in any county. The substitute, in the language of the standing committee's section, was rejected. The section was adopted 19 yeas, 20 nays.

Section 12, relating to the liberty of speech, was not considered. It reads: "The press shall be free, and also to publish any news in any county. The substitute, in the language of the standing committee's section, was rejected. The section was adopted 19 yeas, 20 nays.

Section 13, relating to the liberty of speech, was not considered. It reads: "The press shall be free, and also to publish any news in any county. The substitute, in the language of the standing committee's section, was rejected. The section was adopted 19 yeas, 20 nays.

Section 14, relating to the liberty of speech, was not considered. It reads: "The press shall be free, and also to publish any news in any county. The substitute, in the language of the standing committee's section, was rejected. The section was adopted 19 yeas, 20 nays.

Section 15, relating to the liberty of speech, was not considered. It reads: "The press shall be free, and also to publish any news in any county. The substitute, in the language of the standing committee's section, was rejected. The section was adopted 19 yeas, 20 nays.

Section 16, relating to the liberty of speech, was not considered. It reads: "The press shall be free, and also to publish any news in any county. The substitute, in the language of the standing committee's section, was rejected. The section was adopted 19 yeas, 20 nays.

Section 17, relating to the liberty of speech, was not considered. It reads: "The press shall be free, and also to publish any news in any county. The substitute, in the language of the standing committee's section, was rejected. The section was adopted 19 yeas, 20 nays.

Section 18, relating to the liberty of speech, was not considered. It reads: "The press shall be free, and also to publish any news in any county. The substitute, in the language of the standing committee's section, was rejected. The section was adopted 19 yeas, 20 nays.

Section 19, relating to the liberty of speech, was not considered. It reads: "The press shall be free, and also to publish any news in any county. The substitute, in the language of the standing committee's section, was rejected. The section was adopted 19 yeas, 20 nays.

Section 20, relating to the liberty of speech, was not considered. It reads: "The press shall be free, and also to publish any news in any county. The substitute, in the language of the standing committee's section, was rejected. The section was adopted 19 yeas, 20 nays.

THE OLD WORLD.

RECEIVED BY TELEGRAPH.
DE. 28, Jan. 28.—Fresh outbreak of Rinderpest at Rio de Janeiro.

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A FEMALE CRUSOE.

THE LONE WOMAN OF SAN NICOLAS ISLAND.

A Wonder-Romance in Real Life.—Eleven Years Alone on the Island of San Nicolas.

I well remember that day, beyond Robinson Crusoe in his lonely travels and daily occupations.

It was a strange and romantic story, but such is the fact, and my narrative is not only based upon facts, but in fact, the knowledge of the circumstances which attended the last sickness of my friend, "Crusoe," the heroine of San Nicolas Island.

Having heard that an Indian woman had lived in lonely life for eighteen years—from 1853 to 1871—on one of the many islands off this coast, I was anxious to learn more about it.

Without the aid of glasses he can put a post ball into the hole of a cannon in India. When he was in the United States, he was a trapper and hunterman among the Indians of the north.

Mr. Nidever said: "My occupation has been that of other hunting. When I was in the United States, I was a trapper and hunterman among the Indians of the north."

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SANTA BARBARA.

AND VICINITY.

THE MARKETS.

Weather Report.

DEPARTURES, SANTA BARBARA, S. A. Division of Telegraphic Reports for the District of Commerce and Agriculture.

RAINFALL AT SANTA BARBARA.

Tide-Table for To-morrow.

High Water.

Low Water.

High Water.

Low Water.

High Water.

Low Water.

High Water.

Low Water.

High Water.

Low Water.

High Water.

Low Water.

High Water.

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Tide-Table for To-morrow.

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Low Water.

High Water.

Low Water.

High Water.

Low Water.

High Water.

THIRD TOWNSHIP TRIM.

The Gundulup Telegraph of last Saturday the following are condensed:

It is quite gentle rain commenced this morning, and continued steadily throughout the night.

Chinese New Years commenced on Monday evening, and fire-crackers, chicken and "san-shan" were abundant in Celestial quarters for a few days.

Mr. F. F. Fields, of the Sney ranch, is again recovering from his recent illness.

It is believed that the mail will be delivered on Monday evening, and fire-crackers, chicken and "san-shan" were abundant in Celestial quarters for a few days.

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A FEMALE CRUSOE.

THE LONE WOMAN OF SAN NICOLAS ISLAND.

A Wonderful Romance in Real Life—Eighteen Years Alone on the Island of San Nicolas, on the Coast of Southern California.

Correspondence of The Wisconsin Republican.

SANTA BARRBARA, Cal., Dec. 18, 1878.—I well recollect with what boyish pleasure and absorbing interest I followed Robinson Crusoe in his lonely travels and daily occupations on the island of Juan Fernandez, little thinking that in later years I would find a similar case on this far-off coast; but such is the fact, and my narrative is not only based upon facts, but is fact, the knowledge of the circumstances having been obtained from the discoverers, captors and the physician who attended during the last sickness of my feminine "Crusoe," the heroine of San Nicolas Island.

Having heard that an Indian woman had lived a lonely life of eighteen years—from 1835 to 1853—on one of the many islands off this coast, I was anxious to learn more about it than the varying and contradictory reports in general circulation gave me, but was not able to do so until a short time ago, when, through an interpreter, I consulted Messrs. George Nidever and Charles Brown, two of the party who brought her from the island to this place, and Mrs. Nidever, who had

brought her from the island to this place, and Mrs. Nidever, who had charge of her after she landed. Mr. Nidever is well advanced in years, about eighty, but retains his faculties to a good degree. A frontiersman from early life, he spent many years as trapper and huntsman among the Indians of the northwest previous to coming here in 1835. He became expert in the use of the rifle, and maintains his reputation even to the present day. Without the aid of glasses he can put a pistol ball into the head of a gopher at twenty five feet. Although an American by birth he now converses entirely in the Spanish language. [Not "entirely."—Ed.]

Mr. Nidever said: "My occupation has been that of otter hunting. When I came here in 1835 I found two other Americans, Isaac J. Sparks and Lewis T. Burton, engaged in the same business. They chartered a schooner of twenty tons burden, built at Monterey, called *Pearce's Nola*, (Better than Nothing,) for a trip to the coast of Lower California, on an otter expedition, leaving Santa Barbara about the first of May, 1835. I did not accompany the expedition. Not being as successful as those in charge expected, three months later the *Pearce's Nola* put into San Pedro, the port or landing of Los Angeles, on her return trip. From San Pedro she went to the island of San Nicolas, about seventy miles south west from San Pedro and a little further southeast from Santa Barbara, for the purpose of removing the Indians then on the island to the mainland, and re-

perpetrated, and being the Indians taken on the island to the main land, and returned with eighteen men, women and children as told me by Isaac J. Sparks. How long the Indians had been residents of the island, how they got there, and by whose authority they were removed, I know not. One of the Indians, rather dwarfed in intellect, but possessing the physical strength of three or four ordinary men, remained at San Pedro, two of the women were taken as concubines by two Americans living in Los Angeles County; the balance of the party divided, part going to Los Angeles and part going to San Gabriel Mission. Those two men who selected their concubines from the party took an active part in having the Indians removed.

According to the information I have obtained from the three persons consulted through the interpreter, the history of the Indian woman, the feminine "Curse," was follows. She was absent gathering wood when the others were taken away, but returned to the camp or quarters and finding them deserted, she followed in time to be taken aboard the schooner, but not finding her children there, one a babe at the breast and the other about three years old, she plunged into the water and swam ashore in search of them. Unable to find her children, she returned to the beach just in time to see the schooner leaving. She called to those on board, but the only reply she got and which she remembered to the day of her death, was, "*no answer*," pronounced *mah-nah-nah*, the Spanish

learned *mah-nyah-nah*, the Spanish word for "to-morrow," evidently meaning that the schooner would return for her to-morrow, or the following day. She threw herself down on the beach and cried long and bitterly. She did not find her children, and supposed they were either taken off by the schooner or carried away and devoured by the wild dogs on the island. She became very sick and lay a long time without either water or food, but finally recovered and forgot her grief in wandering about the island. She lived on a plant resembling the cabbage, called by Californians "*palosanto*," and a root known by the name of "*coreomito*;" also a yellow root, the name of which was not given, and seal or sea-lion blubber. As she had abalone-shell fish hooks, and lines made of the sinews of the seal, it is probable she supplied herself with fish from the ocean.

An approaching storm and night coming on, the water being quite shoal about the island and unsafe for a vessel during a high wind, they were compelled to leave for the safety of the schooner, intending to return at a future time for the deserted woman.— The vessel ran before the gale and reached San Pedro harbor in safety; but circumstances did not permit a return prior to the loss of the schooner in a storm a few weeks later, and the distance to the island was too great to be safely made in the small shore boats.

In 1851 Mr. Nidever visited the island otter hunting, and saw signs of a

human inhabitant. He saw a footprint made during the previous rainy season, sunken deeply in the now dry, hard ground, and from the size judged it to be that of a woman. Also, three small circular enclosures about two hundred yards from the beach and about a mile apart. They were about six feet in diameter, made of brush, the walls five feet high, with a small opening on one side. Near these openings were sticks of drift-wood stuck in the ground in the form of a tripod, supporting dried seal blubber. These enclosures appeared to be simply wind breaks, affording no protection from the rain. The investigation was pursued no further, as an approaching storm compelled them to leave the island. Mr. Nidever having seen many otter on his first trip to the island made a second during the Winter of 1852, and being requested by the Mission Fathers of Santa Barbara, had determined to make a careful hunt for the supposed lone inhabitant of the island. The head of the island being better supplied with fresh water, closer to the beach and better facilities for fishing, and the altitude such as to command a view of the greater portion of the island and coast he supposed if alive she would be found there, and made his arrangements accordingly. He and his party found the same, or similar enclosures above mentioned and the

his party found the same, or similar enclosures, above mentioned, and the tripod sticks supporting renewed pieces of blubber. In the neighborhood of the huts or wind breaks, were seven or eight wild dogs about the size of a coyote, (a small wolf on the coast,) and in color black and white. Mr. N. said he had seen the same kind of dogs among the Northwest Indians. They appeared to be very wild. Within half a mile of the head of the island they discovered a basket in the crotch of a bush or small tree, covered with a seal skin, and containing a dress made of shag's skins, (the shag is a species of duck on this coast that can neither walk nor fly,) carefully folded up, and several square pieces of skins similar to those of which the dress was made. Also a rope made of seal sinews, abalone shell fish-hooks, bone needles, etc. As it was late and time for them to return to their boat for the night, Mr. N. scattered the contents of the basket on the ground, so that upon his return he could judge of the presence or absence of the owner, by finding them gathered up or remaining as he left them. The following four or more days were busily spent in otter hunting, and before the search for the Indian woman was renewed a southeast gale compelled them to seek a more hospitable harbor at the Island of San Miguel.

Continued to-morrow.

A GRAPHIC and romantic story of the "Female Robinson Crusoe" of San Nicolas Island is contributed to a ~~Minnesota~~ paper by our fellow-citizen, Dr. A. B. Stuart. The first instalment of it is reprinted in to-day's PRESS. The paper from which we copy, the *Winona Republican*, says:

The remarkable story of adventure printed on this page of the *Republican* to-day would be almost incredible were not the facts vouched for by our correspondent—formerly a well-known resident of this city—based upon evidence which he regards as conclusive. The writer in a private note assures us that he was engaged for several months in gathering and verifying the statements which he embodies in his interesting letter, and his care and industry in preparing the matter for publication deserve much credit.

We learn that the same facts about a curious and real character—the central figure of a wonderful romance in real life—form the subject of an illustrated paper which has been prepared for *Scribner's Monthly* by Mrs. Hardacre, the well-known correspondent. The matter is of absorbing local as well as of general interest.